

Color

Fossilized bones cannot give us information about the color of dinosaurs. However, throughout the animal kingdom, brightly colored feathers or skin are known to instantly attract attention. Dinosaurs like Citipati may have showed off in the same way.



The cassowary's large head crest and multicolored skin ensure this flightless bird never goes unnoticed.

Frills

Meat-eating Cryolophosaurus didn't need a frill for protection. Instead, it is likely that its crest was brightly colored and used for display. It may have appealed to females and scared away rivals. Many ceratopsians had frills for the same reason.



The Atlantic royal flycatcher has a showy forward-facing head frill.

Showing off

In prehistoric times there was fierce competition to attract a mate, just like there is now. Dinosaurs developed special features to show themselves off to potential partners. Many millions of years later, animals today use similar tactics to stand out from the crowd and catch the eye of the opposite sex.